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On deck, a developer's Fenway project

It's been a winding road but Rosenthal ready to reconfigure neighborhood

JON CHESTO
POWER PLAY

Stand with John Rosenthal atop his 15-story apartment complex in the Fenway, and it's hard not to be swept up in the panorama — even if you've visited every skyscraper in the city.

From left to right, you see the pillars of Greater Boston's economy: Kendall Square's labs and university halls. The Financial District towers off in the distance. The Back Bay skyline. The Longwood Medical Ar-

ea. In the foreground: Fenway Park's Green Monster, outfield, grandstands.

And just down below, right at street level, two acres of concrete: the biggest platform to go over the Mass. Turnpike since Copley Place

in the 1980s. With the recent hook-up of electric utility connections, the long-awaited Fenway Center deck over the highway is finally done.

How Rosenthal got here, though, is a story as long as the turnpike itself — one that involves at least two mayors, five governors, countless meals at Eastern Standard, that stolen base by Dave Roberts, and even a friendship between a black Labrador retriever and an English bulldog.

Rosenthal's trek began in 1992, while running his family's real estate business. He acquired the two-

story parking garage on Lansdowne Street, in the shadow of the Green Monster. The garage became lucrative for Rosenthal and his business partners with around-the-clock traffic from hospital workers, baseball fans, and nightclub revelers. Rosenthal also hoisted a 252-foot-long gun-violence prevention billboard on its side facing the turnpike, bringing national attention to that cause.

A ski buddy suggested Rosenthal contact the Mass. Turnpike Authority about internal discussions con-

POWER PLAY, Page A10

Democrats split over no-party primaries

Group seeks ballot question overhauling voting system

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

A group of Massachusetts Democrats is pushing a ballot question this year that would eliminate the state's party primaries, arguing a dramatic overhaul of how residents vote is necessary to create more competitive elections in a state where many top lawmakers often cruise to reelection uncontested.

But the measure is drawing opposition from within both political parties and sowing fractures among Democrats especially — pitting progressives and members of the party's governing body against some of their own who are pressing to eliminate a system that has long delivered Democrats to success.

Activists in the party's left wing are planning to raise money in a bid to persuade voters to reject the plan, which would allow the top two vote-getters in a preliminary election, regardless of party, to advance to the final. They fear it would box out lesser-known candidates who struggle with fundraising.

The ballot question's top supporter, Harvard University professor and one-time gubernatorial candidate Danielle Allen, said it would give voters more choices in races up and down the ballot.

"We have so many elections that are decided in

PRIMARIES, Page A6



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

It's full steam ahead for this MAGA jester

Provocateur amasses millions of online views — and a few arrests

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

Two sides of Robby Roadsteamer (Rob Potylo): hanging loose at his home (top) in Belmont in March and getting arrested at a protest (above right) in Minneapolis in January.

SOMERVILLE — It's like AC/DC always said: "It's a long way to the top if you wanna rock 'n' roll."

The April sun was finally breaking through, but Rob Potylo had been in a basement recording studio for the better part of a week. As a sound engineer fiddled with vocal tracks, Potylo, who's risen to internet fame as his rowdy alter ego, Robby Roadsteamer, bopped his head to "Red MAGA Beret," his cheeky take on the old Prince anthem.

The studio's laid-back vibe — low-slung couches, dim lighting — was a world away from the Trump rallies and anti-ICE protests where he usually performs as Roadsteamer, accruing tens of millions of online views and notching several arrests.

But the quiet helped. Potylo was here to distill his acidic brand of political theater into something more lasting than a social media post: an album, maybe even a limited release vinyl, with photos from his arrests as cover art.



JEN GOLBECK/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROADSTEAMER, Page A10

MGB patients use AI to get appointments

Some doctors, however, say it neglects staffing problem

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Patients have made over 14,000 virtual appointments in the eight months since Mass General Brigham launched its AI-powered platform to connect people who need primary care with telehealth physicians.

30K patients at the least in the MGB system are without a primary care provider

The platform, originally called Care Connect when it debuted in September, features a chatbot that questions the patient, then sets up a telehealth appointment with a physician in as little as half an hour. MGB is among the first health systems nationally to roll out the app.

The platform was originally designed for patients who couldn't find primary care physicians. In February, MGB expanded its use to include patients who might have a primary care provider but want urgent virtual care, including at times when their doctor's office is closed. MGB ditched the name Care Connect and rebranded the service

APPOINTMENTS, Page A7

Libraries link immigrants to heritage, community

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

NEWTON — On the third floor of the Newton Free Library, visitors can thumb through Dostoyevsky's "Crime and Punishment" in the original Russian text, find a Chinese translation of Neil Gaiman's fantasy novel "American Gods," or check out some of John Grisham's thrillers in Korean, Spanish, or Portuguese.

These are but a fraction of the thousands of foreign language titles that take up the bulk of the library's third floor.

For the city's immigrant community — about a quarter of Newton's population is foreign-born — the vast collection keeps them connected to their ancestral homelands. And the library is also a place where immigrants can practice conversational English, pre-

pare for citizenship tests, and build community at a time when the federal government has ushered in one of the most hostile immigration policies in years.

"We always say libraries are for everyone, and when we say everyone, we literally mean everyone," said Helen Lee, supervisor of adult services at the Newton Free Library. "So being able to meet the needs of people in different ways is very important to us."

These services are also being used at a time when towns and cities across Massachusetts are facing budget constraints that some worry could result in cuts.

Maureen Amyot, director of the Massachusetts Board of Library Commissioners, said budget tightening in some towns — in places such as Marblehead and Chilmark

LIBRARIES, Page A7

MAKING THE TRADITIONAL WADDLE



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Jonathan Krygowski, 12, as "Officer Michael," looked over his shoulder to check on the progress of the annual Duckling Day Parade on its way to the Public Garden. The event was one of several with a Mother's Day theme around the Boston area on Sunday. **B3.**



Getting in the ray

Monday: Gray early, sun late.
High 61-66, low 44-49.

Tuesday: A few clouds.
High 60-65, low 45-50.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

President Trump rejected Iran's response to the latest proposal to end the war. **A3.**

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